

Skills Summary

Mass and Liquid Volume: One-Step Problems

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Put Amounts Together: Add

Rule: When two amounts are put together (“in all”, “total”, “altogether”), **add** them. Both amounts must use the *same unit*.

Example: A box holds 250 g of pasta and a jar holds 130 g of rice. What is the total mass?

Step 1. Both masses are in grams and the question asks for the amount all together — that means add.

Step 2. $250 + 130 = 380$.

The total mass is **380 g**

Try it: A can holds 320 g of soup and a cup holds 165 g of yogurt. What is the total mass?

check: 485 g

Take Away or Compare: Subtract

Rule: When an amount is *taken away*, or the question asks “how much more” or “how much is left”, **subtract**.

Example: A bottle holds 600 mL of water. Nia pours out 240 mL. How much water is left?

Step 1. An amount is poured away and the question asks what is left — that means subtract.

Step 2. $600 - 240 = 360$.

There are **360 mL** left.

Try it: A barrel holds 48 L of rainwater. 19 L drains out. How many liters are left?

check: 29 L

Equal Groups: Multiply

Rule: When there are *equal groups* and you want the total, **multiply**: (groups) $\times$ (amount in each group).

Example: One tin of paint has a mass of 3 kg. What is the mass of 6 tins?

Step 1. Every tin has the same mass, so this is equal groups — multiply the number of tins by the mass of one tin.

Step 2. $6 \times 3 = 18$.

The 6 tins have a mass of **18 kg**

Try it: One can of milk holds 4 L. How many liters do 5 cans hold?

check: 20 L

Equal Shares: Divide

Rule: When one total is split into *equal shares* and you want the size of each share, **divide**:
(total) $\div$ (number of shares).

Example: A pitcher holds 18 L of tea, poured equally into 6 jugs. How many liters go into each jug?

Step 1. One total is split into equal shares and the question asks for each share — that means divide.

Step 2. $18 \div 6 = 3$.

Each jug gets **3** L

Try it: A sack of 45 g of seeds is split equally into 9 pots. How many grams go into each pot?

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